



ANTONIO SEMPERE Associated Press

STANDING GUARD

Spanish army soldiers block access to the beach for people crossing from Morocco into the Spanish enclave of Ceuta on Friday. At least 57 people died after about 60,000 crossed in 24 hours. **WORLD, A2**

COURTS RESTORE MIGRANT BOND HEARINGS

Two appellate rulings strike down Trump’s ‘mandatory detention’ expansion policy.

By SONJA SHARP

The U.S. 9th Circuit Court of Appeals dealt another blow to the Trump administration’s mass deportation project Thursday, ruling alongside the 7th Circuit that most immigrants cannot be held without bond while fighting to remain in the U.S.

The rulings will apply to jurisdictions that stretch across much of the southern border, affecting states where large numbers of immigrant detainees are held in federal custody. Unless immigrants are caught while crossing the border or soon after, they will now be entitled to a bond hearing, where a judge will decide whether there is enough evidence to justify their indefinite detention.

The twin decisions come little more than a year after the Department of Homeland Security ordered “mandatory detention” for all immigrants picked up by its agents — a policy that had previously applied only to those caught at the border. The issue now appears likely to be decided by the Supreme Court.

The policy shift sowed chaos in federal courts, as thousands of immigrants began suing for bond hearings that had long been automatic.

California’s district judges were overrun with emergency petitions for writs of habeas corpus, a legal maneuver rarely used outside death row appeals.

“Versions of this case have played out in federal courts across the country,” Judge Daniel A. Bress wrote for the 9th Circuit on Thursday. “The vast majority of the district courts to confront the issue have concluded that [mandatory detention] is limited to the border.”

Those district court battles have grown increasingly heated as caseloads have swelled.

This spring, Eastern District of California Chief Judge Troy Nunley took the rare step of sanctioning a government lawyer over failing to tell the court if and when a man he’d ordered released had actually gone free.

The attorney told Nunley he was drowning in nearly identical cases and had fallen behind with the paperwork. In an interview, Nun- [See **Bond hearings**, A9]

A global milestone for California solar power

In May, over half of its electricity came from sun

By Blanca Begert

California hit a major milestone in May, generating more than half its electricity from the sun in what is believed to be a global first, according to an analysis of federal data.

“California has had a wealth of solar growth in the last five years,” said Abby Lestina, an analyst at Grid Status, a group that tracks electricity supply and demand in U.S. power markets but was not involved with the analysis. “It makes sense that they would reach this goal.”

It’s the first time a large-scale power system is known to have surpassed 50% solar for an entire month.

It’s also the second significant power record set by the state recently. For the first five months of 2026, California made more electricity from solar than from na-

tural gas, according to the U.S. Energy Information Administration. Burning natural gas has long been the dominant source of electricity in the state. This could be the first year that solar beats gas in California’s power mix.

California has been trending in this direction for years, but the boom in new battery storage around the state allows it to save solar power when it’s overabundant and use it when the sun goes down.

“Battery storage has transformed California’s power system,” Nicolas Fulghum of Ember, which did the analysis, wrote. “Batteries now shift huge amounts of solar power from midday into the evening peak, which is what allows this level of solar penetration in the system.”

[See **Solar**, A9]



ERIC THAYER Los Angeles Times

PANELS absorb the sun’s rays at the Pastoria Solar Project in Arvin, Calif. Battery storage has transformed the state’s power system, an analyst says.

L.A. transit needs Olympic feat

World Cup was just a practice session for ’28 Games

By COLLEEN SHALBY

Two years from now, the Olympics will have just wrapped up with the Paralympics on the horizon. Spectators will know which countries dominated, what athletes made history and, perhaps the biggest question of all, how everyone handled the traffic.

Local leaders have pointed to the success of public transit in Los Angeles during the World Cup — a significant, albeit much smaller test run ahead of the 2028 Games — as a sign for what’s to come. Los Angeles Mayor Karen Bass, now Metro’s chair, declared the city ready to host this massive undertaking. But years-long plans to prepare the

sprawling county for hundreds of back-to-back events over several weeks are still far from complete.

“It’s something that can be done very quickly. But the track record of the city of Los Angeles makes me strongly question their ability to do things quickly,” said Juan Matute, deputy director of UCLA’s Institute of Trans- [See **Transit**, A9]

Few contested House races, but high stakes

Even with more safe districts in redrawn map, California holds key to party control.

By JUSTINE MCDANIEL

WASHINGTON — The nation is set to have its least competitive congressional election cycle in years by some measures, with California partly driving the shift.

The redistricting carried out in California and nine other states since 2024 has left the nation with an unusually low number of truly competitive districts, narrowing the battle for U.S. House control in this year’s historically consequential midterms cycle to a few dozen races at best.

In California, that looks like a paradox: The state has both a shrinking number of

political battlegrounds and a handful of critical races that could help decide which party controls the House. Both are a result of Proposition 50, the Democratic-led, voter-passed redistricting effort designed to offset new maps drawn by Republicans in Texas and other states.

Only three California races are rated as competitive by the Cook Political Report, a nonpartisan newsletter, compared with 12 races in 2024 and nine in 2022, according to a Times analysis of Cook data.

California was also the biggest driver in the nationwide decline of competitive seats, according to a separate Cook analysis released Wednesday. Six of the 14 U.S. House seats that dropped out of the swing-seat zone in 2026 were in the Golden State.

“There’s no question that [See **Districts**, A7]

Hamas deal touted amid uncertainties

Group agrees to disarm but issues demands Israel deems to be nonstarters.

By ANA CEBALLOS AND NABIH BULOS

WASHINGTON — President Trump reaffirmed Friday that Hamas has agreed to disarm and relinquish control of Gaza to a newly created Palestinian government, a milestone he cast as a critical step in the long-stalled effort to end the war in the territory.

The agreement, which the president initially announced in a Truth Social post Thursday evening, capped months of negotiations overseen by the Board of Peace, a body created by the Trump administration last year to oversee talks with Hamas and Israel over the future of Gaza.

“As disarmament is completed, Israeli forces will withdraw, and the International Stabilization Force will work with a new Palestinian police force to take responsibility for Gaza being safe for its residents and its neighbors,” Trump wrote.

But uncertainty looms over the agreement, with Hamas saying Friday it would begin disarming only if Israel halts all military operations in Gaza and Israeli officials expressing skepticism about the deal in news interviews Friday. Trump, during a Cabinet meeting Friday at Camp David, Md., acknowledged the possibility of the deal going awry, saying it is likely the agreement’s implementation could go through its “ups and downs.”

“It’s a very complex situation over there,” Trump said. “The people are very complex and difficult.”

[See **Hamas**, A4]

Anthropic says its AI bots went rogue too

Like a recent OpenAI incident, Claude models hacked targets, stoking new concern.

By NILESH CHRISTOPHER

Another leading artificial intelligence company unveiled details of its cutting-edge bot apparently going rogue.

On Thursday, Anthropic said an internal investigation found that its Claude AI models gained unauthorized internet access and hacked three companies during testing. Just last week, ChatGPT-maker OpenAI announced that bots it was developing had escaped what was supposed to be a controlled offline en-

vironment to hack a competitor.

Anthropic said its models, without being asked to, wandered out of a simulated testing environment and gained internet access before executing hacks on the companies.

Anthropic worked with an independent evaluation company, Irregular, that accidentally left internet access open inside what was supposed to be a sealed test environment.

In OpenAI’s case, the firm said its AI models broke out of a supposedly confined offline space, connected to the internet and hacked a \$4.5-billion startup in its attempt to find answers to a test it was being evaluated on. It later revealed that the AI compromised the online [See **Anthropic**, A12]

FIFA president scraps proposal

Plan to sell stakes in the World Cup drew wide backlash and rebukes from governing soccer bodies. **SPORTS, B12**

Letters released in Guthrie case

Ransom notes were apparently sent by those who kidnapped Savannah Guthrie’s mother. **NATION, A6**

Southwest avoids deepest river cuts

Trump administration releases a 10-year plan for cutting water use to prop up the Colorado reservoirs. **NATION, A5**

Reflecting Pool case gets dropped

U.S. moves to dismiss a criminal case charging former Olympian with deliberately damaging the site. **NATION, A6**



JUSTIN SULLIVAN Getty Images

LOW water levels have hit Lake Powell in Page, Ariz.

Weather

Turning sunny; hot. L.A. Basin: 93/68. **B8**

Markets

Opinion Voices **A12**
Obituaries **B3**
Comics **B6**

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